

							
Netgear		Netgear		TP-LINK		TP-LINK	
JNR1010		JNR3210		TL-WR720N		TD-W8968	
1,951		5,037		1,499		3,099	
5 / 0		5 / 5		3 / 0		4	
External		External		Internal		External	
1		2		NA		2	
5		NA		5		5	
0 / 0		1 / 1		0 / 0		1/0	
150		300		150		300	
Y		Y		N		Y	
N		N		N		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
N		N		Y		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
2		2		3		3	
N		N		N		N	
Y		Y		Y		Y	
Zone 1	Zone 2	Zone 1	Zone 2	Zone 1	Zone 2	Zone 1	Zone 2
34.47	33.7	53.94	98.5	15.45	48	25.91	36.6
46.86	52.2	73.52	46.8	43.93	53.1	60.12	48.8
47.52	9.94	76.8	10	17.85	9.97	26.34	9.94
40.25	10	64.5	10	59.36	10	95.57	9.71
13.22	12.31	12.92	12.72	11.4	12.89	12.61	12.87
45	56	46	47	48	49	45	49
27	3	2	0	533	9	2	2
39.94	51.38	27.85	40.56	67.17	48.83	32.9	40.13
38.62	43.98	29.44	33.45	54.78	41.55	34.12	54.78

exceptions to this phenomenon though, the D-Link Belkin AC1200DB and the D-Link DIR-868L. The Tamosoft output of these two routers maintained a steady gradient throughout that particular test. The Belkin AC600DB on the other hand didn't perform well at all. We don't know whether to chalk it up to a messed up

firmware or the placement of the internal antennae but we weren't expecting such results. The TP-LINK WR720N did get past the threshold for HD video streaming but it experienced periodic spikes which was also evident when we were pinging the device, where it averaged 533ms in Zone1. These spikes did interfere with the HD

streaming in a not-so-subtle manner. Digisol routers performed rather well which does compensate for the lack of attention paid to the firmware. The ASUS RT-AC68U turned out to have the highest throughput of them all.

The one thing that we can take away from these tests is that you really don't need an

expensive router unless you have 8-10 devices that really hog bandwidth. Do consider the features on offer across the spectrum as well.

Winners:

Best performer

ASUS RT-AC68U

Aside from the obvious advantage of being a dual band router, the RT-AC68U is packed to the hilt with features. Thus, not only is it capable of an insane throughput but is versatile enough to be adopted into different roles. The only downside is the price at which it comes - ₹18,000. There are very few people who'd need to invest in this behemoth.

Best Buy Single Band

Digisol DG-BR4000N/E

A Digisol router has made it to the podium owing to a stable throughput and a mix of features all put together at the right price. The firmware might be a bit cumbersome to deal with but once it is setup properly it works without any issues. Overall, it was the price to performance ratio that won it the award.

Best Buy Dual Band

D-Link DIR-810L

This router is very discrete with its internal antennae. Great signal range and a good firmware secured this devices Best Buy award.

Editor's Pick

TP-LINK TD-W8968

This router not only features great performance, but also a great price as well. The Digisol router narrowly beat it to Best Buy, but this is one great router and it gives you ADSL2+ support, 8dBi antennae and a great UI. An excellent choice for almost any occasion. 